

Table 44.9 Busted Patterns

Description	Bull Market	Bear Market
Busted patterns count	233 or 28%	39 or 12%
Single bust count	155 or 67%	22 or 56%
Double bust count	11 or 5%	4 or 10%
Triple+ bust count	67 or 29%	13 or 33%
Performance for all busted patterns	45%	24%
Single busted performance	67%	56%
Non-busted performance (horn bottoms)	59%	34%

Table 44.8 shows the performance over three decades. I like to see how the pattern has behaved over time (or misbehaved). Because bear markets only happened in the 2000s, they are not included in the statistics.

Performance over time. Performance has been constant across the three decades with the 2000s suffering more than the other two decades.

Failures over time. The failure rate is highest in the 2000s, which makes sense because it was the worst performing of the three decades.

Table 44.9 shows busted pattern performance.

Busted patterns count. Comparatively few patterns bust, especially in bear markets.

Busted occurrence. When horn tops bust, most of them will be single busted patterns. Oddly, triple (or more) busts come in second place. I've seen that trend in other chart pattern types, too. I try to justify it by knowing that triple+ means three or more busts, but do a lot of patterns bust four, five, or more times?

Busted and non-busted performance. I compared the performance of busted patterns with horn *bottoms*, which I used as a proxy for horn tops with upward breakouts.

Single busted horns outperform the other two types I studied (“all busted” horn tops, meaning single, double, and three or more busts, and “non-busted” horn bottoms).